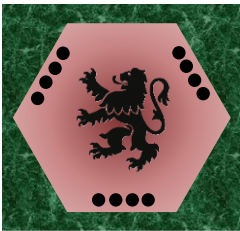


Land of Barons

!\\ The English translation is currently out of date. Refer to the French PDF for the most recent mechanics and balancing.



1. Introduction

In **The Land of Barons**, you play as a **Liege Lord** engaged in the conquest of fractured provinces. Across a domain that takes shape with every battle, your orders are driven by the strategic management of your cards.

Your Lords — your **Baron** and his **Liege Knights** — roam the land to manage your army's logistics: they recruit **Troops**, move your battalions, and order the construction of **Keeps**, the pillars of your conquest.

Troop maneuvers can spark decisive battles, while the strategic placement of your Knights allows you to lock down enemy positions and restrict your rivals' orders.

Who will emerge as the most powerful Baron? Are you ready for an epic adventure where strategy, tactics, and risk-taking collide?



2. General Information

Number of Players	2 to 4
Age	10
Duration	90 minutes
Experience Level	Intermediate Players

Genre
Conquest
Tactical
Logistics

Mechanics
Area Control
Chain of Command
Hand Management

In the **short version** described in §10, a game lasts 30 to 45 minutes



The Land of Barons, Game rules for 2 to 4 players.

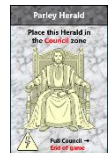
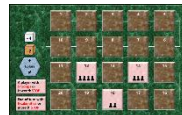
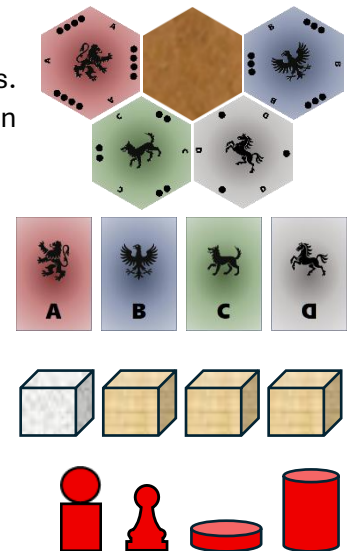
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3. Components

- **37 Hexagonal Tiles:** Double-sided. Front: Lands worth 1, 2, 3, or 4 points. Back: Impassable Mountains (solid brown face). Each tile is identifiable on the front by a color, a crest, and a letter, distributed as follows:
 - 10 Red 4-point Tiles (Lion crest)
 - 9 Blue 3-point Tiles (Eagle crest)
 - 9 Green 2-point Tiles (Wolf crest)
 - 9 Grey 1-point Tiles (Horse crest)
- **37 Position Cards:** Matching the colors, letters, and crests of the Tiles.
- **4 Prestige Cubes:** 1 white cube for the **Free City** and 3 wooden cubes for the **Trading Cities**.
- **1 Score Track**
- **Player Materials (x4 sets):**
 - 1 Large **Baron Pawn**
 - 4 Small **Knight Pawns**
 - **30 Troop Tokens**
 - **10 Small Cylindrical Keeps**
 - **1 Deck of 43 Action cards** (pink, green and grey)
 - **5 Effect cards** (gray with a lightning bolt in the bottom left corner).



4. Goal of the Game – Game End – Winner

4.1. Goal of the Game

Your goal is to accumulate the most points by asserting your dominance through the construction of **Keeps**. Your total score is the sum of three types of gains:

1. **Land Points:** The value of each Tile where you own a Keep.
2. **Prestige Points:** Bonuses granted if your Keeps occupy Tiles containing the **Free City** or **Trading Cities**.
3. **Diversity Points:** A bonus rewarding the variety of crests (Land colors) you have conquered.

Land Points	
Grey Land (Horse)	1 point
Green Land (Wolf)	2 points
Blue Land (Eagle)	3 points
Red Land (Lion)	4 points

Prestige Points	
Trading City	2 points
Free City	4 points

Diversity Points	
2 colors	2 points
3 colors	3 points
4 colors	4 points

Important Note: The **score track** monitors scores in **real-time**. Update it at the end of each player's turn whenever Keeps are built or destroyed. **No points are permanent:** scores depend solely on the current state of the board. If a Keep is removed, all associated gains are instantly lost: **Land Points**, **Prestige Points**, and even the **Diversity bonus**, which must be recalculated based on your remaining Land colors.

4.2. Game End

The game ends immediately at the end of the active player's turn if any of the following **three conditions** are met:

- **Supremacy:** The active player reaches or exceeds the **Critical Point Threshold**. *Their influence is so great that their rivals have no choice but to bend the knee.*
- **Exhaustion:** The active player has **5 or fewer Troops** remaining (total on the board and in their supply). *Too much blood has been shed, and the heralds sound the end of the conflict.*
- **Diplomacy:** The number of **Parley Heralds** gathered at the **Council** reaches the critical Diplomacy threshold. *The clash of arms fades before negotiations, freezing the Barons' positions.*

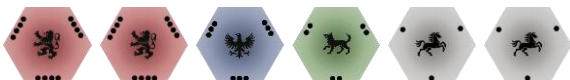
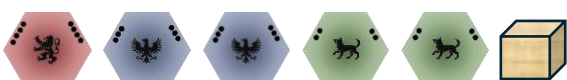
Critical Thresholds			
Configuration	Supremacy	Exhaustion	Diplomacy
2-Player Game	18 points	5 Troops	2 Heralds
3-Player Game	14 points	5 Troops	2 Heralds
4-Player Game	12 points	5 Troops	3 Heralds

4.3. Determining the Winner

Once the end of the game is triggered, the player with the **highest score** wins. In the event of a tie, the following tie-breakers are used in order:

1. **Most Keeps** on the board.
2. **Most Troops** available (total on the board and in the supply).
3. If the tie persists, the players **share the victory!**

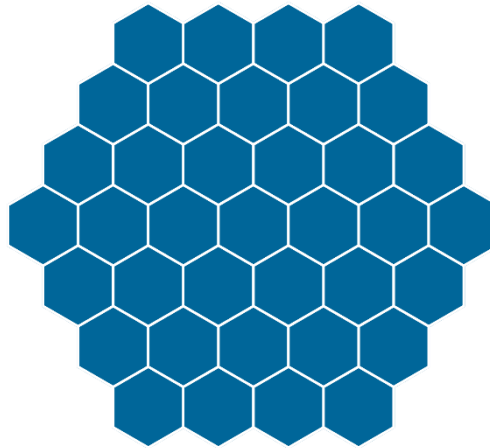
4.4. Scoring Examples

Conquests	Land Points	Prestige	Diversity	Total
	$4+4+4+4 = 16$	4	0	20
	$4+4+3+3 = 14$	$2+2=4$	2	18
	$4+4+3+2+1+1 = 15$	0	4	19
	$4+3+3+2+2 = 14$	2	3	19

5. Setup

5.1. Shaping the Terrain

- **The Board** – Shuffle the **Tiles** and arrange them with the "crest" side visible following the hexagonal pattern below (a large hexagon with 4 tiles per side).



- **Special Positions** – Shuffle the 37 **Position cards**. For each step below, announce the element, draw a card, and place the element on the corresponding Tile:
 - **Mountains:** Draw **4 cards**. Flip the designated Tiles to their brown side (crests hidden).
Important: Permanently remove these 4 cards from the game.
 - **Free City:** Draw **1 card** and place the **white cube** on the designated Tile.
 - **Trading Cities:** Draw **3 cards** and place the **wooden cubes** on the designated Tiles.

5.2. Initial Deployment

Before players choose their sides, draw the starting **Positions** for each color in play:

- **One Tile** for the **Baron**.
- **One Tile** for the **first Knight**.
- **One Tile** for the **second Knight**.

Important: Permanently remove any **Position card** from the game after it is drawn.

Vigilance (Blocking and Balance)

- **Accessibility:** If a Baron, a Knight, the Free City, or a Trading City is isolated from the rest of the board by Mountains, redraw its Position card.
- **Connectivity:** If the terrain is too fragmented or if Tile colors are too clustered (creating unbalanced zones), players are encouraged to perform a full reshuffle of the board.

5.3. Preparation of the Liege Lords

- **Turn Order** – Play proceeds clockwise. To determine the first player, each player draws one Position card. The first player is the one with the **lowest-ranked card** based on the following hierarchy:

- **Crest Value:** Horse (1) < Wolf (2) < Eagle (3) < Lion (4).
- **Letter:** A < B < C < D...

Examples: A Wolf card (2) plays before a Lion card (4). Between two Wolf cards, Wolf "A" plays before Wolf "B".

- **Choosing Colors** – Starting with the **last player** and moving counter-clockwise, each player chooses a color and collects their materials.
- **Supply Setup** – Each player places the following in front of them:
 - Their **Liege Knights** (2 in the supply; the other 2 already on the board).
 - **10 Keeps** and **30 Troops**.
- **The Deck** – For your first deck cycle (*the Age of Building*):
 - **Set aside** the 3 advanced Action cards ("Recruit Knight", "Exile Knight", "Spy") and the 5 Effect cards (gray cards with a lightning bolt in the bottom left corner).
 - Shuffle your **40** remaining **Action cards** to form your face-down deck.
- **The Barons' Oath (Simultaneous Mulligan)** – Before the first player opens hostilities, all players proceed simultaneously:
 - **Draw** an initial hand of **6 cards**.
 - **Decision:** If you are unsatisfied with your hand, you may take a single **free Mulligan**.
 - **Procedure:** Return your 6 cards to your deck, reshuffle, and draw your final hand of 6 cards. *Once all Lords have sworn an oath upon their hand, the conquest begins!*

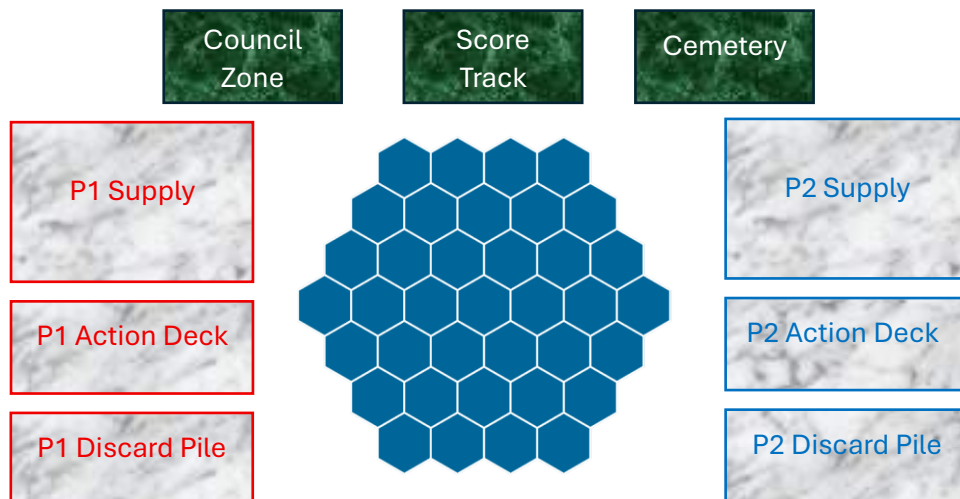
5.4. Table Layout

- **Cemetery:** Designate a shared space (e.g., the box lid) for all **Troops** permanently leaving the game (due to combat or construction).
- **Council Zone:** Reserve a central space for the **Parley Herald Effect cards**. They remain there face up, *marking the progression toward the ratification of the Peace Treaty*.
- **Score Track:** Place the track where everyone can see it. Each player places one **Keep** in front of the "1" space to mark their starting influence.

The conquest begins! The **first player** opens hostilities, followed by the other players in **clockwise order**.



Below is the table layout diagram for a 2-player game

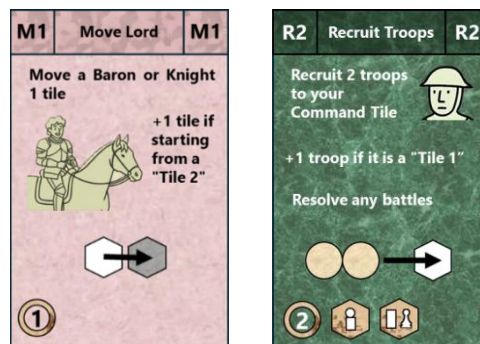


6. Turn Sequence

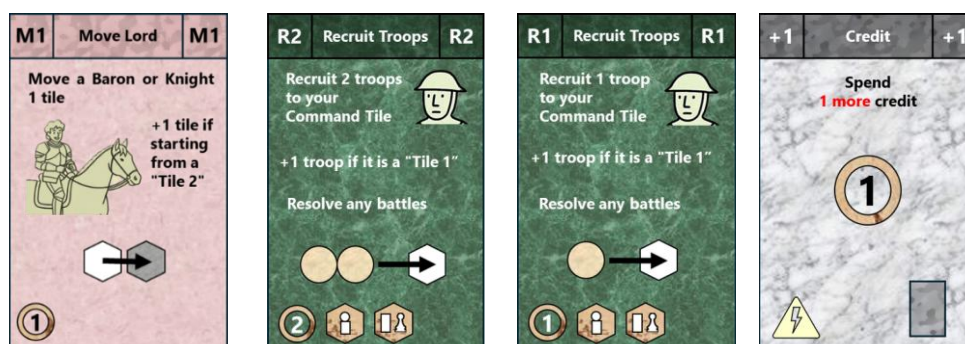
On your turn, you must choose **one** of the following two options:

Option A — Take Action

1. **Plan** – From your hand, choose **at least 1 Action card** and, optionally, one or more **Effect cards**.
 - Effect cards (with a lightning bolt in the bottom left) have a cost of 0.
 - The **total cost of the Action cards** (indicated in the bottom left) must not exceed the amount of credits available for your turn. This amount is **3 credits by default**, but can exceptionally increase to 4 if you play the "+1 Credit" Effect card.



Example: Playing 2 cards with costs of $1 + 2 = 3$ credits



Example! Playing 3 cards with costs of 1+2+1 = 4 credits

2. **Act** – Execute the instructions of the chosen cards following these rules:

- **Free Order and Association:** You choose the sequence in which you resolve your cards. Effect cards are used in different ways: some act independently (like the Parley Herald), others must be explicitly associated to an Action card to modify its effect. It is possible to associate multiple compatible Effect cards with a single Action card. In all cases, an Effect card is single-use and fully consumed upon resolution (see §9 for details).
- **Independence:** Each played element (an Action card with its potential Effects, or an independently acting Effect card) must be resolved fully before moving to the next. A resolution may alter the board state, thus influencing the conditions for subsequent elements played during the same turn.
- **Discard:** Once played, place your cards face-up in your personal Discard Pile.
- **The Council:** If you played the **Parley Herald** Effect card, do not discard it: place it permanently, face up, in the **Council** zone.

3. **Reinforce** – Refill your hand until you have **6 cards**.

4. **Update (End of Turn)**

- Update the **Score Track** based on the final state of the board.
- Check if a threshold for **Supremacy** (points), **Exhaustion** (remaining troops), or **Diplomacy** (Heralds at the Council) is reached. If so, the game ends immediately.

Option B — Replan

If you choose **not** to play any Action cards:

1. **Purge:** Discard **between 1 and 6 cards** from your hand to your personal Discard Pile. Note: If you discard the **Parley Herald** Effect card, place it permanently, face up, in the **Council** zone
2. **Renew** – Refill your hand until you have **6 cards**.
3. **Update (End of Turn)** – As with Option A, update the **score** and check the game-end conditions. The automatic placement of a Parley Herald in the Council zone during this phase may trigger the end of the game.

7. Managing the Deck and Discard Pile

- **Transparency:** Your opponents may ask to examine the cards you have just discarded during your turn. Once the examination is complete, only the top card of the pile remains visible.
- **Confidentiality:** Aside from this immediate consultation, the contents of the discard piles are secret. No player may browse their own discard pile or that of a rival.
- **Deck Cycle (Reshuffling – *The Age of Intrigues*):** As soon as your deck is exhausted and you still need to draw cards to complete your hand:

1. First, draw any remaining cards from the deck, if there are any.
2. If this is the first reshuffle (your deck's second cycle), insert the following **8 new cards** into your discard pile:

○ The **5 Effect cards** (gray background with a lightning bolt in the bottom left corner): "**Parley Herald**", "**Baron Incognito**", "**+1 Credit**", "**+1 Move Lord**", and "**+1 Recruit Troops**".

○ The **Spy Action** card (gray background).

○ The **Recruit Knight Action** card (pink background).

○ The **Exile Knight Action** card (pink background).
- The first keeps have been erected and borders now touch. The war bogs down on the battlefield, giving way to shadow maneuvers. Lines of communication are compromised by Spies, Knights face Exile, while Heralds actively work at the Council to impose peace.*
3. If this is the second reshuffle (your deck's third cycle), do not insert any new cards into your discard pile.

4. Shuffle the cards in **your discard pile**.

5. Form your **new deck** and finish completing your hand.
8. Action Card Effects
- Action cards are divided into three types, identified by their background color, as shown in the figure below:
- **Pink Background:** Lord Actions (Baron or Knight).

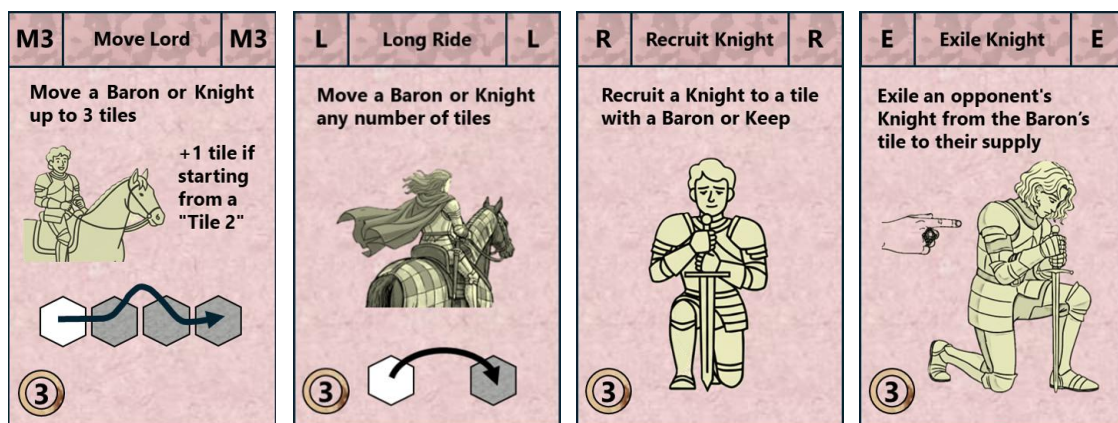
• **Green Background:** Troop Actions.

• **Grey Background:** Action on your hand or an opponent's hand.
- The image displays three distinct action cards from the game. The first card, 'Move Lord', has a pink background and features an illustration of a knight on horseback; its text instructs the player to move a Baron or Knight up to 3 tiles, with a bonus tile if starting from a 'Tile 2'. The second card, 'Recruit Troops', has a green background and shows a helmet icon; it allows recruiting 2 troops to a Command Tile, with an additional troop if it's a 'Tile 1', and then resolving any battles. The third card, 'Court Intrigue', has a grey background and depicts two figures in conversation; it requires drawing 6 cards and then discarding down to 6 cards in hand. Each card includes a cost icon in the bottom left corner: a circle with '3' for the first, a circle with '2' for the second, and a circle with '3' for the third.
- The following table provides a summary of the 43 Action cards. For each card, its name, type (via background color), cost, and quantity are listed.
- Action cards are described in detail by type in the following sections.

Action Card	Credits	Quantity	Groups		
Move Lord 3	3	4	15		
Move Lord 2	2	5			
Move Lord 1	1	6			
Recruit Troops 3	3	2	9	17	23
Recruit Troops 2	2	3			
Recruit Troops 1	1	4			
Concentrate Troops	1	3	8	6	6
Disperse Troops	1	5			
Build Keep	3	6	6	6	
Long Ride	3	1	5		
Recruit Knight	3	1			
Exile Knight	3	1			
Court Intrigue	3	1			
Spy	2	1			

8.1. Lord Action Cards

Below are the effects of Action cards played on a Lord.



- **Move Lord 3** – Move one Lord (Baron or Knight) up to **3 Tiles**. The movement does not have to be in a straight line.
 - **Bonus:** If your Lord starts their movement on a **2-point Tile (Wolf)**, they gain **+1 Movement** (*representing a lush green land where they can regain their strength*).
 - **Constraints:**
 - ✓ Neither a **Baron** nor a **Knight** may cross or occupy a **Mountain Tile**.
 - ✓ A **Knight** has no other crossing or occupation constraints.
 - ✓ A **Baron** must **not cross or occupy** a Tile occupied by an **enemy Baron** or an **enemy Keep**.
 - ✓ A **Baron** may cross or occupy a Tile occupied by allied or enemy **Troops** and **Knights**.
- **Move Lord 2** – Identical to "Move Lord 3," but with a maximum distance of **2 Tiles** (plus any potential terrain bonus).

- **Move Lord 1** – Identical to "Move Lord 3," but with a maximum distance of **1 Tile** (plus any potential terrain bonus).
- **Long Ride (Rare)** – Choose one Lord (Baron or Knight) currently on the board and move them directly to **any Tile of your choice**, respecting the occupation restrictions listed under "Move Lord 3."
- **Recruit Knight (Rare)** – If you have a Knight remaining in your supply, place that Knight directly onto a Tile occupied by your **Baron** or one of your **Keeps**.
- **Exile Knight (Rare)** – If an **enemy Knight** is present on the same Tile as your **Baron**, that Knight is sent back to the **opponent's supply**. If multiple enemy Knights are on your Baron's Tile, this effect **only** applies to **one** of them.

8.2. Combat – Control – Command

Before describing the **Troop Action cards** in §8.3, three key mechanics must be detailed:

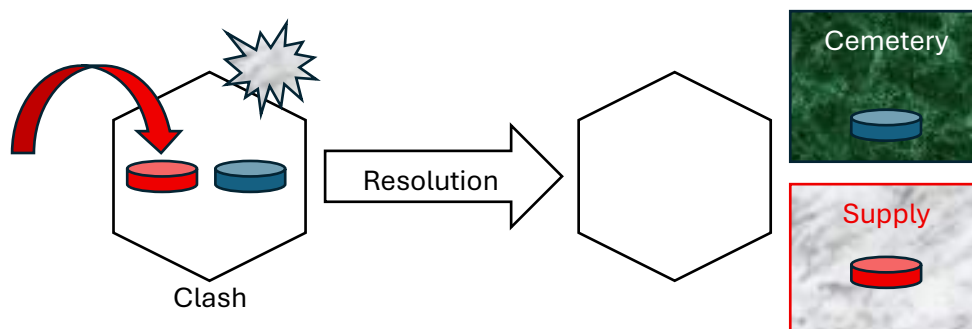
- **Clash Resolution:** Resolving "Troops vs. Troops" and "Troops vs. Keep" encounters.
- **Knight Control:** How Knights lock down a Tile.
- **Troop Command:** Issuing orders to Troops from a Tile.

8.2.1. Clash Resolution

Clashes occur in the following situations. Resolving each clash is **mandatory and immediate**.

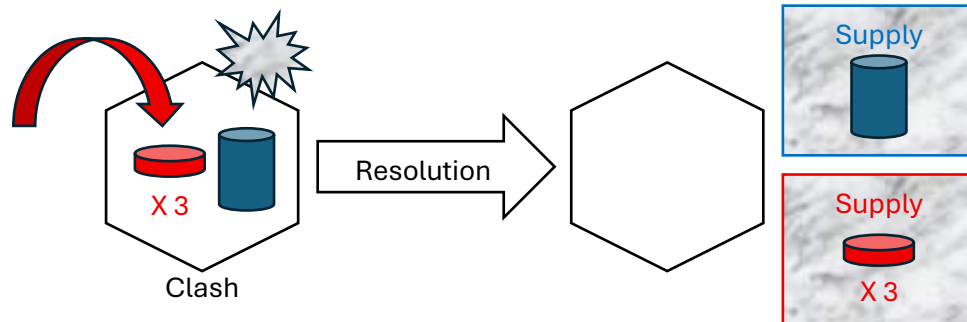
The Vanguard Rule – When performing a **Concentrate** or **Disperse** action, you may freely organize your engaged Troops into **multiple Assaults**. For each Assault, only the specific number of Troops necessary to resolve the combat (the **Vanguard**) is used. It is the number of attacking Troops present on the Tile **at the conclusion of an individual Assault** that determines the effect triggered on a Keep (Destruction or Capture)

- **Troop Clash** – On a Tile occupied by enemy Troops, the arrival of one or more of your Troops triggers a clash:

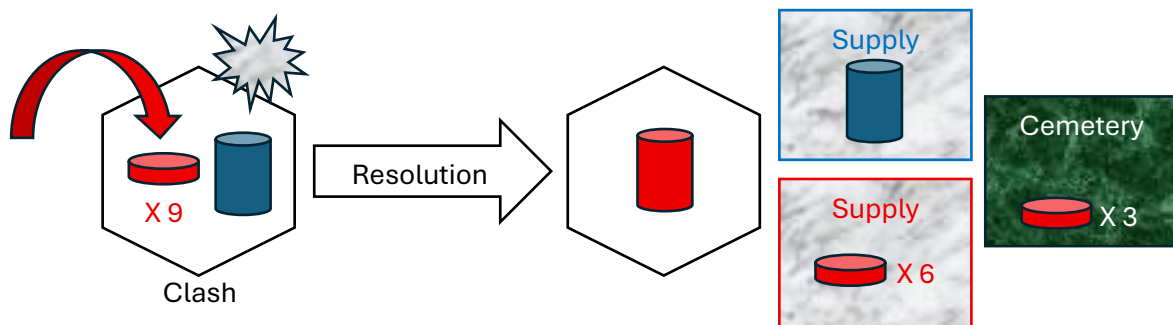


- The principle is: **1 Troop versus 1 Troop**.
- Your **Troop** is the **attacker**. It is returned to your **Supply**.
- The enemy **Troop** is the one being **attacked**. It is sent to the **Cemetery**.
- Resolving **Troop Clashes** takes **priority over Keep Clashes** (see Keep Destruction or Capture).

- **Keep Destruction** – On a Tile occupied by an enemy Keep, the presence of your Troops may trigger a clash:



- The principle is: **3 Troops versus 1 Keep**.
 - If, at the conclusion of an individual Assault, the presence of your **attacking Troops** is **equal to or greater than 3** (without reaching the Capture threshold), the **Destruction** clash is triggered.
 - The **enemy Keep** is destroyed and returned to its owner's **Supply**.
 - Your **3 attacking Troops** are returned to your **Supply**.
- **Keep Capture** – This is a powerful variation of "Keep Destruction":



- The principle is: **9 Troops versus 1 Keep + 1 Keep**.
 - If, at the conclusion of an individual Assault, the presence of your **attacking Troops** is **equal to or greater than 9**, the **Capture** clash is triggered.
 - The **enemy Keep is destroyed** and returned to its owner's **Supply**.
 - You immediately build a **Keep** of your own color on the Tile.
 - **3 attacking Troops** are sent to the **Cemetery**.
 - **6 attacking Troops** are returned to your **Supply**.

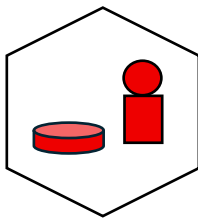
The Rearguard Rule – If you move more Troops than necessary for a clash, the remaining units form the **Rearguard**. Their behavior depends on the action being performed:

1. **Concentration:** The Rearguard continues its movement toward the Command Tile.
2. **Dispersion:** The Rearguard must stop on the Tile where the clash occurred.

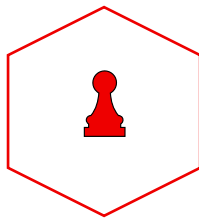
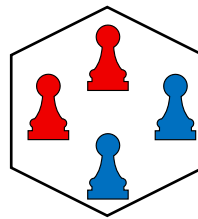
8.2.2. Controlling a Tile

A Tile is considered **controlled** by a **color** if that color has **strictly more Knights** on the Tile than any other individual enemy color.

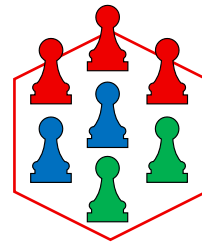
- **Ties or Absence:** If no color has a **majority**, or if there are no Knights present, the Tile is considered **uncontrolled**.
- **Note:** Barons, Troops, and Keeps never factor into the calculation for controlling a Tile; **only Knights** are taken into account.
- **Note:** "Controlling a Tile" can block or limit the abilities of a "Command Tile," as explained in §8.2.3.
- **Examples of Tile Control:**
 - **1 Red Knight:** Controlled by the **Red side**.
 - **2 Red vs. 2 Blue:** Tie → **no control**.
 - **3 Red vs. 2 Blue vs. 2 Green:** Red majority → controlled by the **Red side**.



No Control

Controlled by **Red**

No Control

Controlled by **Red**

8.2.3. Command Tile

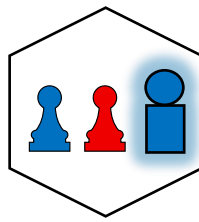
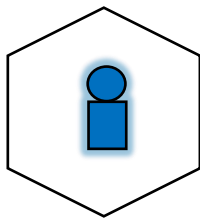
To play any **Troop Action card**, you must **designate** a **Command Tile**. There are three types of Command Tiles, each offering different capabilities:

	Baron	A Tile with your Baron can: Recruit, Build, Concentrate, and Disperse.
	Keep + Knight	A Tile with one of your Keeps and one of your Knights can: Recruit, Concentrate, and Disperse.
	Keep	A Tile with only one of your Keeps can: Concentrate and Disperse.

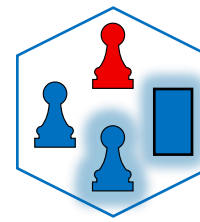
Knight Control Restrictions:

- You **cannot designate** a **Command Tile** if it is **controlled** (see §8.2.2) by **enemy Knights**. Your Command Tile must be either uncontrolled or controlled by your own Knights.
- The "**Keep + Knight**" Command Tile loses some of its capabilities if **enemy Knights** are present and **your Knights do not hold a majority** (i.e., they are at a tie, see §8.2.2). In

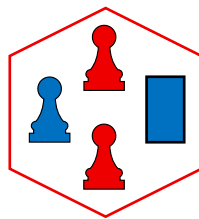
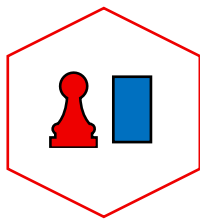
this situation, your Knights are considered engaged in a standoff and **cannot proceed** with the **recruitment** of **Troops**.



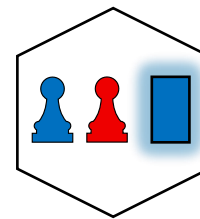
Blue Baron Command Tiles



Blue Keep + Knight Command Tile



Tiles **Controlled** by **Red**;
Command lost by **Blue**

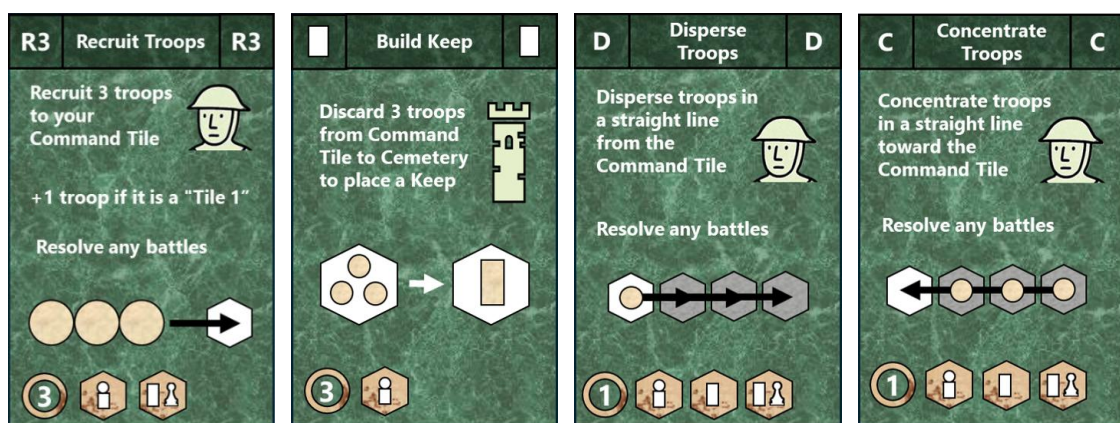


Blue Keep Command Tile

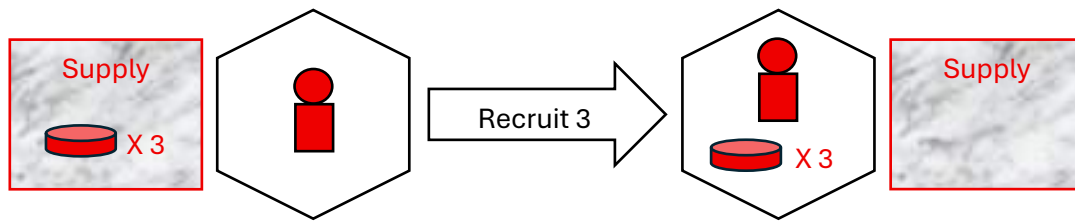
8.3. Troop Action Cards

Now that you are familiar with the mechanics of clashes, Tile control, and Command Tiles (see §**Erreur ! Source du renvoi introuvable.**), you are ready to explore the effects of Troop Action cards.

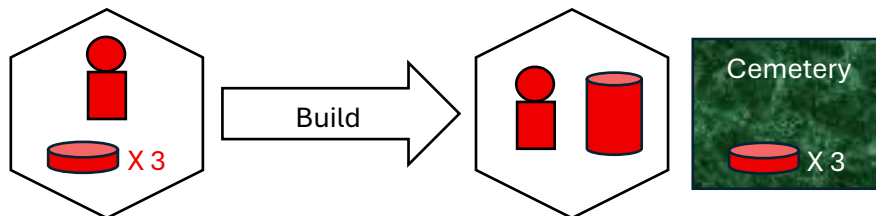
The authorized Command Tiles for each card are indicated by **hexagonal icons** at the bottom of the Action card (see figure below).



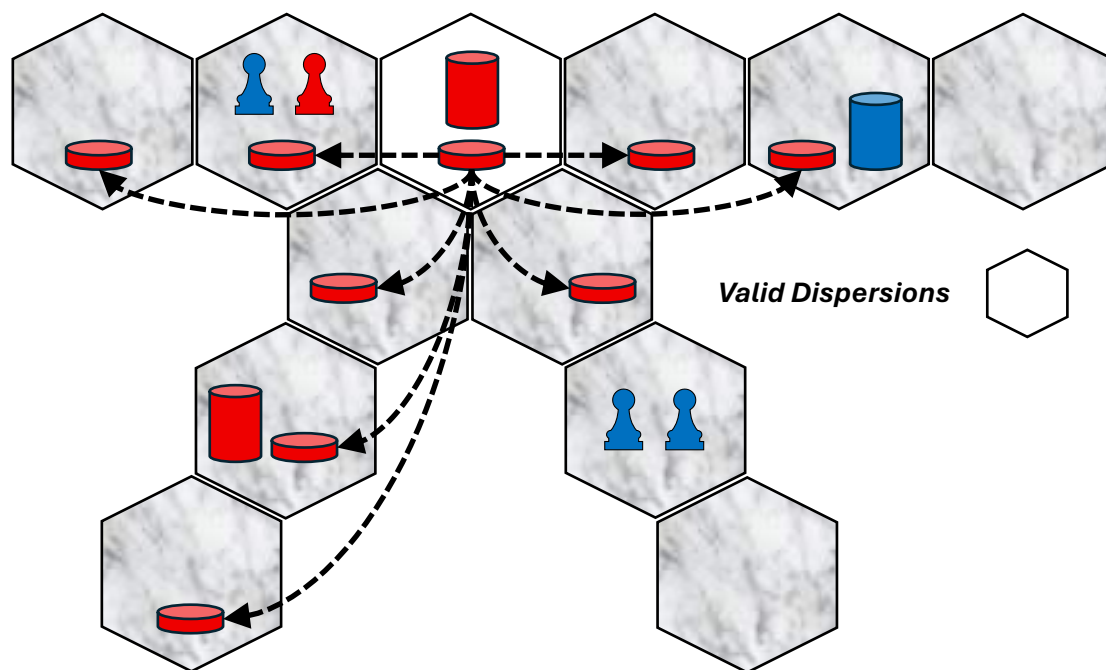
- **Recruit Troops 3** – On the designated Command Tile, recruit **3 Troops** taken from your supply. If the Command Tile is a **1-point Tile (Grey)**, you gain a **bonus of 1 Troop** (*representing a poor land where it is easy to find recruits*). Furthermore:
 - If your supply is not empty but does not contain enough Troops, recruit as many as possible. If your supply is completely empty, you cannot play this card.
 - **Enemy Troops** occupying your Command Tile **do not block** recruitment. However, your newly recruited Troops must **clash with them immediately** (see §8.2.1).



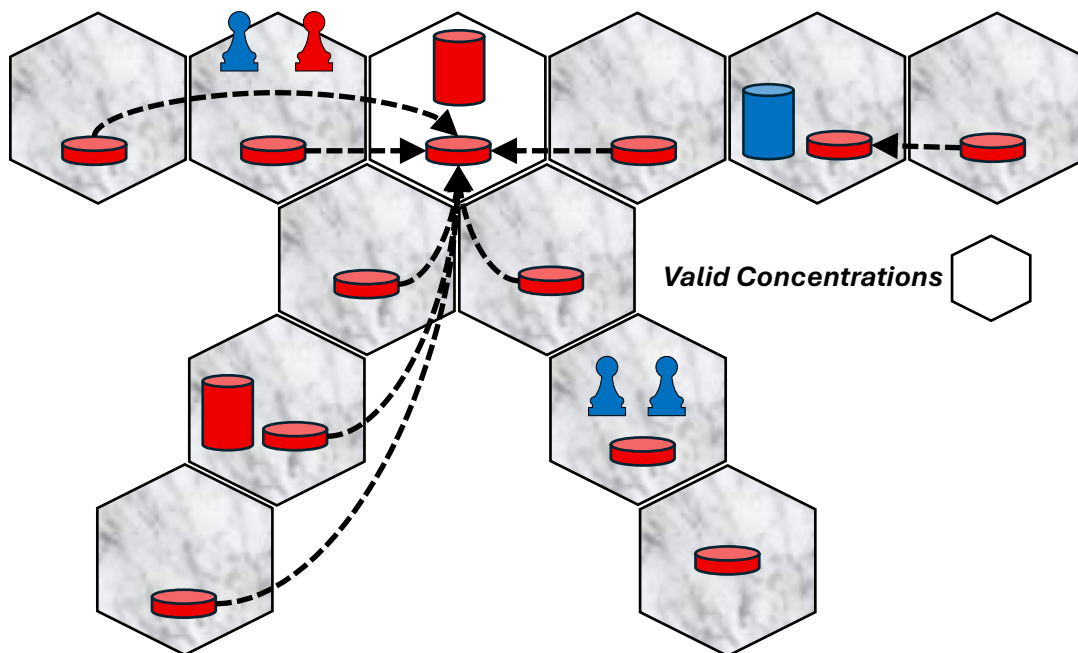
- **Recruit Troops 2** – Identical to "Recruit Troops 3," but you recruit only **2 Troops** (plus any potential terrain bonus).
- **Recruit Troops 1** – Identical to "Recruit Troops 3," but you recruit only **1 Troop** (plus any potential terrain bonus).
- **Build Keep** – Discard **3 Troops** from the designated Command Tile to the **Cemetery** and place a **Keep** on that Tile. **Constraints:**
 - **A Tile** may be occupied by **only one Keep**.
 - **Two Keeps**, whether allied or enemy, **must not be adjacent** to each other.



- **Disperse Troops** – From the designated Command Tile, move some or all of your Troops:
 - Each Troop moves in a **straight line** in its own direction, as far as you choose.
 - A Troop may not cross or occupy a **Mountain Tile** or a **Tile controlled by enemy Knights** (see §8.2.2).
 - A Troop must stop to **resolve** any Troop or enemy Keep **clash** (see §8.2.1).
 - A Troop must stop when entering a Tile with an **enemy Keep**, even if no clash is triggered. If no clash occurs during this action, this Troop may be concentrated or dispersed during a future action.

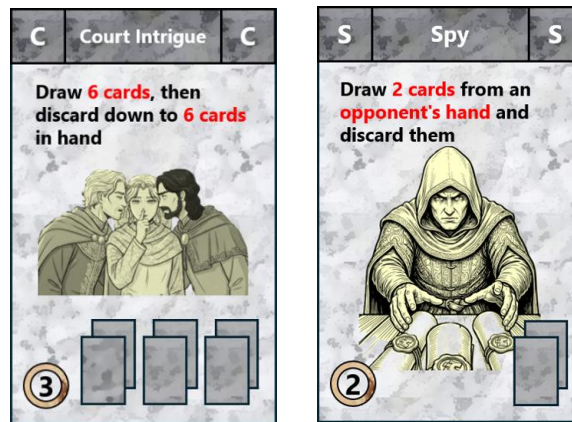


- **Concentrate Troops** – Toward the designated Command Tile, move some or all of your Troops that are aligned with said Command Tile:
 - Same rules as "Disperse Troops," but with the movement direction reversed. Specific rules are detailed below.
 - Each Troop moves in a straight line, **as close as possible to the Command Tile**. Any clashes triggered along the way are resolved immediately (see §8.2.1).
 - The concentration **order cannot pass through** a **Mountain Tile** or a **Tile controlled by enemy Knights** (see §8.2.2). Consequently, your Troops located on or beyond a Tile controlled by an opponent cannot be concentrated.



8.4. Hand Action Cards

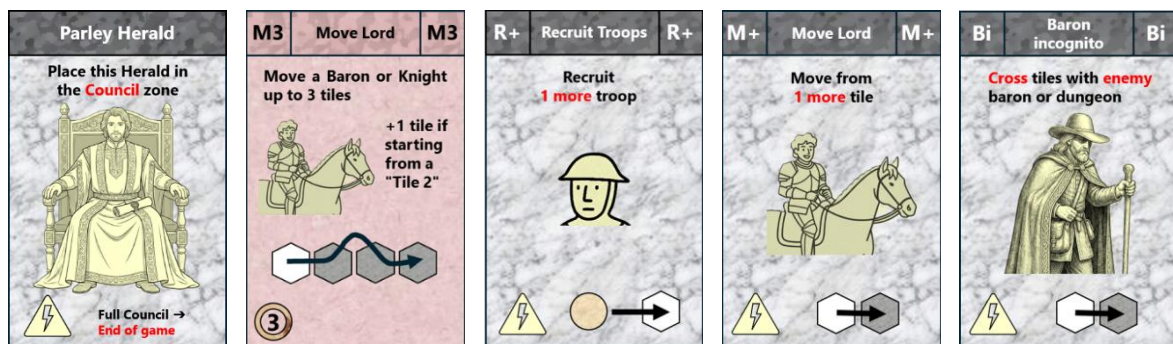
Here are the Action cards that affect your hand or an opponent's hand:



- **Court Intrigue (rare)** – After discarding "Court Intrigue", you first add **6 cards** to your hand from your deck. Then, you **discard** cards to keep only 6 in hand. **At the end of the "Court Intrigue" Action, you have 6 cards in hand, so you do not draw anything during the "Reinforce" phase.**
- **Spy (rare)** – Choose an **opponent**. Draw **2 cards at random** from their hand. **Reveal** these 2 cards **to all players** before discarding them: if the **"Parley Herald"** is among the drawn cards, it is placed in the **Council** zone instead of being discarded. The other cards are placed in your **opponent's discard pile**.

9. The Effect Cards

Here are the Effect cards that act independently or in association with Action cards.



An Effect card is identifiable by the lightning bolt in the bottom left corner. Reminder: Effect cards only enter your deck starting from its second cycle.

- **Parley Herald:**
 - This Effect card is played alone, either voluntarily, or automatically in any case of discard from your hand.
 - Place this card in the **Council** zone.
 - At the end of the active player's turn, check the **Diplomacy threshold**.

- If this card is discarded from your hand by an opponent's effect (e.g., Spy), it is placed in the Council zone instead of your discard pile.
- **Additional Credit:**
 - This Effect card is played alone, during the Plan phase of Option A.
 - This Effect card increases by 1 credit the amount available to play your Action cards during this turn.
- **Additional Recruitment:**
 - This Effect card is played in association with a "Recruit Troops" Action card (regardless of its value).
 - This Effect card increases by 1 the number of Troops recruited by the Action card.
- **Additional Movement:**
 - This Effect card is played in association with a "Move Lord" Action card (regardless of its value).
 - This Effect card increases the maximum movement distance by 1 Tile.
- **Baron Incognito:**
 - This Effect card is played in association with a "Move Lord" Action card.
 - This card exceptionally allows the moving the Baron being moved to **cross** (without stopping on) Tiles occupied by **enemy Barons** or **enemy Keeps**.

10. Short Version – End by Abdication

For faster and more intense games, this version is played until the exhaustion of a single deck cycle. The war effort is lightning-fast and leaves no time for the negotiations and intrigues of the second cycle.

10.1. Preparation of the Deck and the Remnant

Each player's deck strictly consists of their **40 base Action cards**. The 8 advanced cards are left in the box.

Before starting the game, after drawing an initial hand of 6 cards and **resolving a potential Mulligan** (if you chose to discard and redraw your initial hand), each player takes **the first 6 cards** from their deck. These cards are set aside, face down, to form their **Remnant**. The rest of the cards make up their main deck.

10.2. The End of Reign Countdown

Players draw normally from their main deck. When a player's main deck is empty, the countdown mechanic is triggered: the player then spreads the 6 cards of their **Remnant** in front of them, face down. From now on, for the "Reinforce" (Option A) or "Renew" (Option B) step, they draw directly from these spread cards. This allows all players around the table to visualize exactly how many actions the Baron has left before their inevitable fall.

10.3. The STOP by Abdication

The game ends immediately during the active player's turn if they find themselves in one of these two paralyzed situations:

- **Inability to draw:** The player no longer has enough cards in their spread Remnant to refill their hand to 6 cards.
- **Decision paralysis:** The player is completely unable to act on the board (no card in their hand offers a valid action) **AND** they no longer have enough cards in their Remnant to allow for a voluntary discard.

Lockdown Rule: It is strictly forbidden to discard (Option B - Replan) or play the *Court Intrigue* card if the visible Remnant does not contain enough cards to refill the hand back to a full 6 cards. The action cannot be initiated.

10.4. Resolution and Scoring

When a player is forced into Abdication, the game ends immediately. The players then proceed to the final scoring to determine the winner, exactly as with the other game-end conditions (the sum of Land Points, Prestige Points, and Diversity Points).

Abdication incurs no penalty. A Baron feeling their authority erode can absolutely use this limit tactically to freeze the board state and win if they are already leading in points!

11. Reference Sheet

